

Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church - Our Beliefs & Values

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Servants Lessons

Debre Mihret St. Michael Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church
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THE ORTHODOX CREED

We believe in one God, God the Father the Pantocrator who created heaven and earth, and all things seen and unseen. We believe in one Lord Jesus Christ, the Only-Begotten Son of God, begotten of the Father before all ages; Light of Light, true God of true God, begotten not created, of one essence with the Father, by whom all things were made; Who for us men and for our salvation came down from heaven, and was incarnate of the Holy spirit and the Virgin Mary and became Man. And He was crucified for us under Pontius Pilate, suffered and was buried. And on the third day He rose from the dead,

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according to the scriptures, ascended to the heavens; He sits at the right hand of his Father, and He is coming again in His glory to judge the living and the dead, Whose kingdom shall have no end.

Yes, we believe in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the Life-Giver, Who proceeds from the Father, Who with the Father and the Son is worshipped and glorified, who spoke by the prophets.

And in one, holy, catholic and apostolic church. We confess one baptism for the remission of sins. We look for the resurrection of the dead, and the life of the coming age. Amen.

God

God is the completely holy and sovereign creator and sustainer of the universe. He exists in three persons: the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit. All three persons are co-equal and co-eternal but are distinct from one another.

1 Samuel 2:2, 1 Chronicles 29:11-12, Isaiah 6:3, 46:10, Matthew 28:19, 2 Corinthians 13:14

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Man

God created man in His image. Out of all of creation, man is set apart as God's special image bearer which gives all people inherent worth and special responsibility. Man was created to know God and worship God.

Genesis 1:26, 2:7, Isaiah 43:7

Sin

Due to the disobedience of Adam and Eve, sin entered the world and broke God's good creation. The effects of sin permeate all of creation including people. Sin separates a person from God, from their true selves and from others. Because of sin, man stands guilty before God, deserves punishment, and is incapable of loving, worshipping or cherishing God.

Genesis 3, Psalm 51:5, Romans 3:23, 5:12, 6:23,
Ephesians 2:1-3

Salvation

The sinful state that man is in cannot be overcome by any of his own efforts. God, according to his grace, offers salvation to man as a free gift that is obtained through faith in the work of Jesus on the cross. Those on whom the work of Jesus is effective are born again: they are given a new heart that loves God, hates sin and desires to live an obedient life.

This salvation has essentials like faith, baptism, sacraments of the church, and good works.

John 3:16-18, 2 Corinthians 5:17, Ephesians 2:4-10

Jesus

Jesus Christ is the Son of God. He is both fully God and fully man. Jesus lived a perfect life and died as a sacrifice for the sins of the world. He rose bodily from the grave three days after being buried to display His victory over sin, Satan and death. Jesus will one day return to earth and reign as king.

Isaiah 42:1, John 1:1-5, 10:30, 14:6, Romans 6:4,
Colossians 1:19-2

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Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit is the third person of the Trinity. He empowers believers to live the life God has called them to, inspired the scriptures, illuminates the word of God, and convicts' people of sin. By the Holy Spirit believers have spiritual gifts that they use to serve the local/parish church.

John 14:26, 16:7-15, Romans 8:26, 12:6-8 Galatians
5:22-25

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Church

A church is a localized community of baptized believers committed to one another and the mission of God who gather regularly with recognizable leadership, practice the church sacraments, and function as a team and family.

1 Timothy 3:15, Titus 1:5-9, Hebrews 10:24-25

Baptism

Our Church practices the ordinance of baptism. Baptism is one of the first acts of obedience for a follower of Jesus. The event demonstrates the person's new life in Jesus. Orthodox Tewahedo Church (our church) practices baptism by immersion.

Mark 16:16, Acts 2:38

Communion

Our Church practices the ordinance of communion.

Communion is taken to commemorate and
symbolize the work of Jesus on the cross – the bread
symbolizes His broken body and the wine
symbolizes His shed blood.

John 6:53-57, 1 Corinthians 11:23-26

The Kingdom

The kingdom of God is His rule, reign and authority.

His kingdom is present in this world but not fully expressed. When a person is born again, in essence that person's citizenship is transferred from the kingdom of darkness into the kingdom of God. One day, God's rule, reign and authority will be perfectly expressed "on earth as it is in heaven."

Psalm 103:19, Luke 1:32-33, John 3:5-7

Family

Marriage is a covenantal relationship instituted by God that is between a man and a woman and provides the foundation for a family. Sexual activity is to only be practiced within a lifelong, covenantal, monogamous, heterosexual marriage.

Genesis 2:23-24, Matthew 19:6, 1 Corinthians, 6:9-20, Ephesians 5:22-33.

Eternity

Man was created to exist forever. Those who are in Christ will spend eternity on the new heavens and new earth in new life under the rule and reign of the good king Jesus Christ, forever. Those who reject Jesus will experience the wrath of God and spend eternity separated from God in hell.

Matthew 25:41-46, 2 Corinthians 5:21, 1 John 5:11-12



Glory be to the Holy Trinity

The Father, The Son, and The
Holy Spirit ONE GOD

Amen!